

Review Checklist

Run effective static reviews and catch defects before code runs.

Introduction

Reviews are static testing: they find defects in work products without executing code. This checklist helps you run reviews that are consistent, objective and genuinely useful, aligned to syllabus Chapter 3.

Review Types (formality low to high)

Type	Characteristics
Informal review	No formal process; main purpose is inexpensive benefit
Walkthrough	Led by the author; find defects, improve, share understanding
Technical review	Led by a moderator; performed by technical peers; reach consensus
Inspection	Most formal; follows rules and roles; metrics-driven

Roles in a Formal Review

Role	Responsibility
Author	Creates and fixes the work product under review
Manager	Plans reviews, decides on their execution
Facilitator (moderator)	Ensures the review runs effectively
Review leader	Takes overall responsibility for the review
Reviewer	Identifies potential defects
Scribe (recorder)	Records the outcomes and defects found

Before the Review

- Objectives are clear and agreed.

- The right reviewers are invited for the material.
- The work product meets entry criteria (stable enough to review).
- Reference material (standards, checklists) is available.
- Reviewers have had adequate time to prepare individually.

During the Review

- Focus on finding defects, not fixing them.
- Critique the work product, not the author.
- Every reviewer participates and raises findings.
- Findings are recorded objectively by the scribe.
- Time-box the session to keep it effective.

Content Quality Checks

- Requirements are complete, consistent and unambiguous.
- Each requirement is testable (you can write a test for it).
- Terminology is used consistently throughout.
- No contradictions between related statements.
- Assumptions and dependencies are stated explicitly.
- Acceptance criteria are defined and measurable.

After the Review

- Defects are logged and assigned for resolution.
- The exit decision (accept / rework) is recorded.
- Metrics are captured (for formal reviews).
- Rework is verified before closing.

Why Reviews Pay Off

Defects found in reviews are cheaper to fix than those found in later dynamic testing or production, because the cost of fixing a defect rises the later it is found.

Best Practices

- Match review formality to the risk of the work product.
- Use checklists to keep reviews consistent.
- Keep the tone constructive — reviews improve products, not blame people.

Common Mistakes

- Turning the review into a fixing session.
- Reviewing without preparation time.
- Criticising the author instead of the artefact.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

The single most valuable question in any requirements review is: "How would I test this?" If you cannot answer, the requirement is not yet testable — and that is a defect worth logging now.